

REFERENCE

REF A

How to read a card

DRIVER — the reusable cause (class) + its fact_type

STATE — the event-level state word — this deck = all 27

NUMBERS — level / change / compare (— = null)

QUOTE — verbatim source text = the truth

SCOPE — which version of the fact · source · date

VERDICT — the separate EXPLAINED_BY edge — only if it moved the stock

Hidden edges every card has: OF_DRIVER→Driver, FROM_SOURCE→Event.
id = event ⊕ driver ⊕ scope. ★ STATE ≠ direction ≠ good/bad.

REFERENCE

REF B

The 4 fact_types

metric — a standing variable you can re-read (incl. qualitative)

guidance — the company's own forward outlook

surprise — an actual result vs an expectation

action_event — a discrete thing that happened

Decider metric vs action: can you re-read a standing level between two events? yes → metric · no → action_event. Dual framing: dividend (action) vs dividend_per_share (metric).

REFERENCE

REF C

The verdict edge

stock_impact — long / short — can oppose the net move

weightage — 0.1-1.0 — a FORCE, not a share; never summed; nullable

confidence — 0-100 — how sure the attribution is true

produced_mode — live (PIT-clean) / backfill

llm_producer — earnings-learner (filings) / news-driver (news)

It hangs on the Event (Event→fact) so it is graded vs the real return. A fact can exist with NO verdict.

METRIC

#01

increased

direction stated — up

DRIVER same_store_sales

level1.6 percent_yoy

change—

compare—

“Comparable sales increased 1.6% versus the prior-year quarter.”

company_comp_sales · 8-K · 2024-10-29

VERDICT ▲ long · w 0.4 · conf 60

METRIC

#02

decreased

direction stated — down

DRIVER labor_cost

level35.1 percent

change−40 basis_points

compare—

“Labor as a percentage of sales decreased 40 bps to 35.1%.”

labor_pct_of_sales · 8-K · 2024-10-29

VERDICT ▲ long · w 0.3 · conf 50 (cost fell = good)

METRIC

#03

unchanged

explicit flat number

DRIVER average_unit_volume

level12.2 m_usd

change—

compare—

“AUV remained flat at approximately \$12.2 million.”

auv · 10-Q · 2024-11-05

VERDICT — no verdict · reported only

METRIC#04

mixed

one driver: up in parts & down in others

DRIVERcomparable_sales

level—

change—

compare—

“Comparable sales were mixed — off-premise growth offset by softer dine-in traffic.”

company_comp_sales · transcript · 2024-10-29

VERDICT — no verdict · no clear net push

METRIC#05

reported

bare value — no compare, no direction

DRIVERaverage_check

level28.40 usd

change—

compare—

“Average check was \$28.40 in the quarter.”

average_check · transcript · 2024-10-29

VERDICT — no verdict · not the move’s driver

METRIC#06

persists

ongoing condition, no up/down

DRIVERcommodity_cost

level—

change—

compare—

“Commodity cost pressures remained elevated during the period.”

commodity_costs · 10-Q · 2024-11-05

VERDICT ▼ short · w 0.3 · conf 50

METRIC#07

unknown

real fact, no readable state

DRIVERforeign_exchange

level—

change—

compare—

“Results were affected by foreign currency; the net effect was not quantified.”

fx_impact · 10-K · 2025-02-26

VERDICT — no verdict · direction unreadable

GUIDANCE#08

introduced

first time issued

DRIVERrevenue_guidance

level3600–3700 m_usd

change—

compare— (no prior)

“We are initiating FY2025 revenue guidance of \$3.6 to \$3.7 billion.”

FY2025_revenue · 8-K · 2025-02-26

VERDICT ▲ long · w 0.4 · conf 60

GUIDANCE#09

raised

prior guide moved up

DRIVEReps_guidance

level3.70–3.80 usd

change—

compare3.55–3.65 previous_guidance

“We now expect full-year EPS of \$3.70–\$3.80, up from our prior \$3.55–\$3.65.”

FY_eps · 8-K · 2024-07-31

VERDICT ▲ long · w 0.6 · conf 80

GUIDANCE#10

lowered

prior guide moved down

DRIVERcomparable_sales_guidance

level0-1 percent_yoy

change-

compare2-3 previous_guidance

"We are lowering our full-year comparable-sales outlook to flat-to-up-1%, from 2-3%."

FY_comp_sales · 8-K · 2024-10-29

VERDICT ▼ short · w 0.7 · conf 80

GUIDANCE#11

reaffirmed

kept the same

DRIVERcapital_expenditure_guidance

level180 m_usd

change-

compare- (held)

"We reaffirmed our capex guidance of approximately \$180 million for the year."

FY_capex · transcript · 2024-07-31

VERDICT — no verdict · a reaffirm rarely moves px

GUIDANCE#12

withdrawn

guidance pulled

DRIVERrevenue_guidance

level-

change-

compare-

"Given the uncertainty, we are withdrawing our previously issued FY2020 guidance."

FY2020_revenue · 8-K · 2020-03-23

VERDICT ▼ short · w 0.6 · conf 70

GUIDANCE#13

unknown

rare last resort

DRIVERfull_year_guidance

level-

change-

compare-

"Management referenced its full-year guidance without specifying any change."

FY_outlook · transcript · 2024-07-31

VERDICT — no verdict · no change stated

SURPRISE#14

beat

actual > expectation

DRIVEReps_surprise

level1.30 usd

change+0.10 usd

compare1.20 consensus

"Adjusted EPS of \$1.30 beat the \$1.20 consensus estimate."

Q_eps · 8-K · 2024-10-29

VERDICT ▲ long · w 0.7 · conf 80

SURPRISE#15

in_line

actual ≈ expectation

DRIVERrevenue_surprise

level918 m_usd

change-

compare918 consensus

"Revenue of \$918 million matched the \$918 million consensus."

Q_revenue · 8-K · 2024-10-29

VERDICT — no verdict · matched — no surprise

SURPRISE#16

missed

actual < expectation

DRIVER

comparable_sales_surprise

level0.5 percent_yoy

change-1.3 percent_points

compare1.8 consensus

"Comparable sales rose 0.5%, below the 1.8% analysts expected."

Q_comp_sales · 8-K · 2024-10-29

VERDICT ▼ short · w 0.8 · conf 90

SURPRISE#17

unknown

rare last resort

DRIVER

eps_surprise

level—

change—

compare—

"Whether earnings topped Wall Street forecasts was unclear; estimates varied widely."

Q_eps · news · 2024-10-29

VERDICT — no verdict · not readable

ACTION EVENT#18

at_risk

specific threat — not happened, not own plan

DRIVER

labor_strike

level—

change—

compare—

"The union warned workers may strike if no contract is reached by month-end."

union_labor_strike · news · 2024-09-10

VERDICT ▼ short · w 0.4 · conf 50 · news-driver

ACTION EVENT#19

announced

own plan, not yet done

DRIVER

share_repurchase

level200 m_usd

change—

compare—

"The Board authorized a new \$200 million share repurchase program."

buyback_authorization_2025 · 8-K · 2025-02-26

VERDICT ▲ long · w 0.5 · conf 60

ACTION EVENT#20

occurred

happened / deal closed

DRIVER

acquisition

level353 m_usd

change—

compare—

"The Company completed its acquisition of North Italia and Fox Restaurant Concepts."

★ real event — CAKE 2019

north_italia_fox · 8-K · 2019-10-02

VERDICT ▲ long · w 0.4 · conf 50

ACTION EVENT#21

continued

prior action still ongoing

DRIVER

restructuring

level—

change—

compare—

"The company continued executing its previously announced restructuring plan."

2024_restructuring · 10-Q · 2024-11-05

VERDICT — no verdict · ongoing, no new stage

ACTION EVENT

#22

resolved

two-sided dispute settled

DRIVER

legal_settlement

level45 m_usd

change—

compare—

"The company settled the wage-and-hour class action for \$45 million."

wage_hour_class_action · 8-K · 2024-05-14

VERDICT ▲ long · w 0.3 · conf 40 (overhang removed)

ACTION EVENT

#23

canceled

the company's OWN withdrawal

DRIVER

initial_public_offering

level—

change—

compare—

"The company withdrew its planned IPO, citing unfavorable market conditions."

ipo_2022 · news · 2022-09-20

VERDICT — no verdict · minor for the issuer

ACTION EVENT

#24

suspended

paused — can resume

DRIVER

dividend

level—

change—

compare—

"The Board suspended the Company's quarterly cash dividend, effective immediately."

★ real event — CAKE 2020

quarterly_dividend · 8-K · 2020-04-21

VERDICT ▼ short · w 0.8 · conf 90

ACTION EVENT

#25

rumored

3rd-party report, unconfirmed

DRIVER

company_sale

level—

change—

compare—

"Bloomberg reported the company is exploring a potential sale to private equity."

potential_sale · news · 2023-08-15

VERDICT ▲ long · w 0.6 · conf 60 · news-driver

ACTION EVENT

#26

failed

blocked by an OUTSIDE party

DRIVER

merger

level—

change—

compare—

"After the FTC won a court order blocking the deal, the merger was called off."

proposed_merger · news · 2024-01-30

VERDICT ▼ short · w 0.8 · conf 80 (target loses premium)

ACTION EVENT

#27

unknown

rare last resort

DRIVER

corporate_transaction

level—

change—

compare—

"An 8-K disclosed a material transaction whose status was not specified."

undisclosed_transaction · 8-K · 2024-12-01

VERDICT — no verdict · status not specified

DRIVER · CLASS NODE

REAL

same_store_sales

a standing variable you can re-read (incl. qualitative)

PROPERTIES

id

companies

fact_type

first_seen

evidence

driver:same_store_sales

CAKE

metric ·assigned

2023-02-22

56 real refs

EVIDENCE · REAL QUOTE

“Our revenue growth is primarily driven by new restaurant openings and increases in comparable restaurant sales.”

10-K · 2026-02-23 · 0001104659-26-018643

EDGES

OF_DRIVER

SAME_AS

MAPS_TO_CONCEPT

← 0 · producer not run yet

→ 0 · self-canonical head

→ none (null)

REAL Driver record — CAKE catalog, run 2026-06-10. fact_type is assigned by the classifier (the catalog stores none); evhash16 is excluded on the class.

DRIVER · CLASS NODE

REAL

revenue_guidance

the company's own forward outlook

PROPERTIES

id

companies

fact_type

first_seen

evidence

driver:revenue_guidance

CAKE

guidance ·assigned

2023-02-22

24 real refs

EVIDENCE · REAL QUOTE

“we anticipate total revenue for fiscal 2024 to be approximately \$3.57 billion”

10-Q · 2024-11-04 · 0001410578-24-001742

EDGES

OF_DRIVER

SAME_AS

MAPS_TO_CONCEPT

← 0 · producer not run yet

→ 0 · self-canonical head

→ us-gaap:Revenues

REAL record (CAKE, run 2026-06-10). The MAPS_TO_CONCEPT → us-gaap:Revenues link is a real optional_link captured by the run.

DRIVER · CLASS NODE

REAL

eps_surprise

an actual result vs an expectation

PROPERTIES

id

companies

fact_type

first_seen

evidence

driver:eps_surprise

CAKE

surprise ·assigned

2023-02-22

16 real refs

EVIDENCE · REAL QUOTE

“Net income and diluted net income per share were \$54.8 million and \$1.14, respectively, in the second quarter of fiscal 2025.”

8-K · 2025-07-29 · 0001104659-25-071758

EDGES

OF_DRIVER

SAME_AS

MAPS_TO_CONCEPT

← 0 · producer not run yet

→ 0 · self-canonical head

→ us-gaap:EarningsPerShareDiluted

REAL record (CAKE, run 2026-06-10). The consensus a surprise is measured against lives on the (not-yet-built) DriverUpdate, never on the class.

DRIVER · CLASS NODE

REAL

dividend

a discrete thing that happened

PROPERTIES

id

companies

fact_type

first_seen

evidence

driver:dividend

CAKE

action_event ·assigned

2023-02-22

12 real refs

EVIDENCE · REAL QUOTE

“Future decisions to pay or to increase or decrease dividends or to repurchase shares are at the discretion of the Board”

10-Q · 2024-08-05 · 0001410578-24-001151

EDGES

OF_DRIVER

SAME_AS

MAPS_TO_CONCEPT

← 0 · producer not run yet

→ 6 in: cash_dividend, dividend_payment, ...

→ us-gaap:PaymentsOfDividendsCommonStock

REAL record (CAKE, run 2026-06-10) with 6 real SAME_AS variants collapsing into this head — each variant keeps its own evidence.

NOTES

spare card

NOTES

spare card

METRIC

#01

increased

direction stated — up

DRIVER

same_store_sales

level

change

compare

company_comp_sales · 8-K · 2024-10-29

VERDICT ▲ long · w 0.4 · conf 60

METRIC

#02

decreased

direction stated — down

DRIVER

labor_cost

level

change

compare

labor_pct_of_sales · 8-K · 2024-10-29

VERDICT ▲ long · w 0.3 · conf 50 (cost fell = good)

METRIC

#03

unchanged

explicit flat number

DRIVER

average_unit_volume

level

change

compare

auv · 10-Q · 2024-11-05

VERDICT — no verdict · reported only

METRIC

#04

mixed

one driver: up in parts & down in others

DRIVER

comparable_sales

level

change

compare

company_comp_sales · transcript · 2024-10-29

VERDICT — no verdict · no clear net push

METRIC

#05

reported

bare value — no compare, no direction

DRIVER

average_check

level

change

compare

average_check · transcript · 2024-10-29

VERDICT — no verdict · not the move's driver

METRIC

#06

persists

ongoing condition, no up/down

DRIVER

commodity_cost

level

change

compare

commodity_costs · 10-Q · 2024-11-05

VERDICT ▼ short · w 0.3 · conf 50

METRIC#07

unknown
real fact, no readable state

DRIVERforeign_exchange

level

change

compare

fx_impact · 10-K · 2025-02-26

VERDICT — no verdict · direction unreadable

GUIDANCE#08

introduced
first time issued

DRIVERrevenue_guidance

level

change

compare

FY2025_revenue · 8-K · 2025-02-26

VERDICT ▲ long · w 0.4 · conf 60

GUIDANCE#09

raised
prior guide moved up

DRIVEReps_guidance

level

change

compare

FY_eps · 8-K · 2024-07-31

VERDICT ▲ long · w 0.6 · conf 80

GUIDANCE#10

lowered
prior guide moved down

DRIVERcomparable_sales_guidance

level

change

compare

FY_comp_sales · 8-K · 2024-10-29

VERDICT ▼ short · w 0.7 · conf 80

GUIDANCE#11

reaffirmed
kept the same

DRIVERcapital_expenditure_guidance

level

change

compare

FY_capex · transcript · 2024-07-31

VERDICT — no verdict · a reaffirm rarely moves px

GUIDANCE#12

withdrawn
guidance pulled

DRIVERrevenue_guidance

level

change

compare

FY2020_revenue · 8-K · 2020-03-23

VERDICT ▼ short · w 0.6 · conf 70

GUIDANCE

#13

unknown

rare last resort

DRIVER

full_year_guidance

level

change

compare

FY_outlook · transcript · 2024-07-31

VERDICT

— no verdict · no change stated

SURPRISE

#14

beat

actual > expectation

DRIVER

eps_surprise

level

change

compare

Q_eps · 8-K · 2024-10-29

VERDICT

▲ long · w 0.7 · conf 80

SURPRISE

#15

in_line

actual ≈ expectation

DRIVER

revenue_surprise

level

change

compare

Q_revenue · 8-K · 2024-10-29

VERDICT

— no verdict · matched — no surprise

SURPRISE

#16

missed

actual < expectation

DRIVER

comparable_sales_surprise

level

change

compare

Q_comp_sales · 8-K · 2024-10-29

VERDICT

▼ short · w 0.8 · conf 90

SURPRISE

#17

unknown

rare last resort

DRIVER

eps_surprise

level

change

compare

Q_eps · news · 2024-10-29

VERDICT

— no verdict · not readable

ACTION EVENT

#18

at_risk

specific threat — not happened, not own plan

DRIVER

labor_strike

level

change

compare

union_labor_strike · news · 2024-09-10

VERDICT

▼ short · w 0.4 · conf 50 · news-driver

ACTION EVENT#19

announced
own plan, not yet done

DRIVER

share_repurchase

level

change

compare

buyback_authorization_2025 · 8-K · 2025-02-26

VERDICT ▲ long · w 0.5 · conf 60

ACTION EVENT#20

occurred
happened / deal closed

DRIVER

acquisition

level

change

compare

north_italia_fox · 8-K · 2019-10-02

VERDICT ▲ long · w 0.4 · conf 50

ACTION EVENT#21

continued
prior action still ongoing

DRIVER

restructuring

level

change

compare

2024_restructuring · 10-Q · 2024-11-05

VERDICT — no verdict · ongoing, no new stage

ACTION EVENT#22

resolved
two-sided dispute settled

DRIVER

legal_settlement

level

change

compare

wage_hour_class_action · 8-K · 2024-05-14

VERDICT ▲ long · w 0.3 · conf 40 (overhang removed)

ACTION EVENT#23

canceled
the company's OWN withdrawal

DRIVER

initial_public_offering

level

change

compare

ipo_2022 · news · 2022-09-20

VERDICT — no verdict · minor for the issuer

ACTION EVENT#24

suspended
paused — can resume

DRIVER

dividend

level

change

compare

quarterly_dividend · 8-K · 2020-04-21

VERDICT ▼ short · w 0.8 · conf 90

ACTION EVENT#25

rumored
3rd-party report, unconfirmed

DRIVERcompany_sale

level
change
compare

potential_sale · news · 2023-08-15

VERDICT ▲ long · w 0.6 · conf 60 · news-driver

ACTION EVENT#26

failed
blocked by an OUTSIDE party

DRIVERmerger

level
change
compare

proposed_merger · news · 2024-01-30

VERDICT ▼ short · w 0.8 · conf 80 (target loses premium)

ACTION EVENT#27

unknown
rare last resort

DRIVERcorporate_transaction

level
change
compare

undisclosed_transaction · 8-K · 2024-12-01

VERDICT — no verdict · status not specified

NOTES

spare card

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